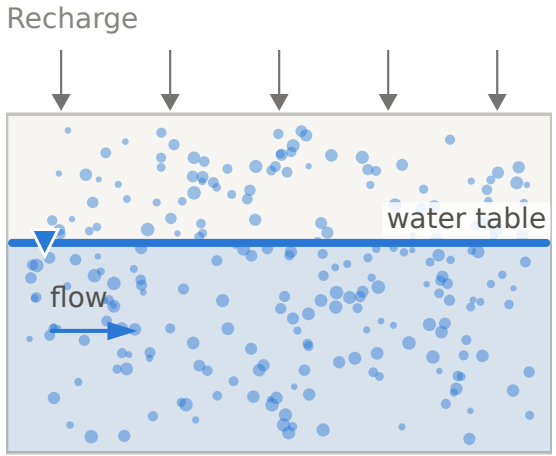
Three aquifer media, three ways water moves

Schematic. Arrow length indicates relative transmissivity; storage runs the opposite way.

Porous

Intergranular pore space

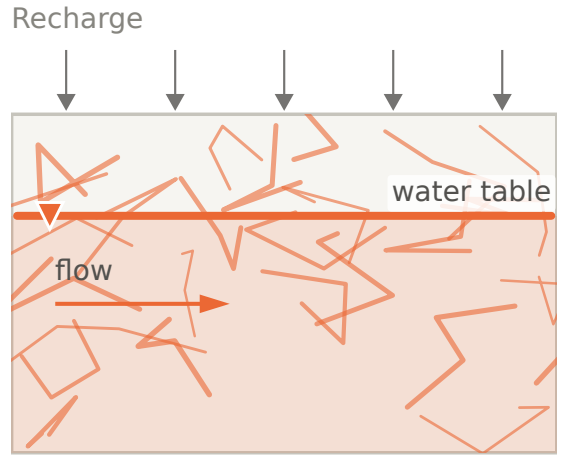


Slow, diffuse seepage through the matrix

Low transmissivity
High storage

Fissured

Connected fracture network

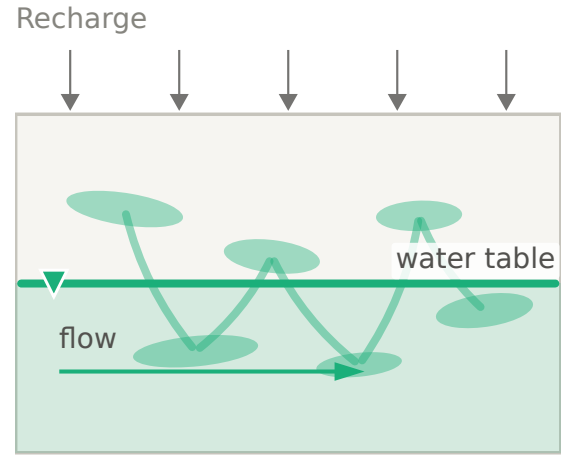


Moderate flow along fractures

Moderate transmissivity
Low storage

Karstic

Dissolution conduits and caves



Rapid conduit flow, flashy response

Very high transmissivity
Very low storage